DAY 34 | PRE-READ

From Prototype to Production Service

A light read before Day 34. About 15 minutes, no code required.

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Why read this?

A prototype that works for one person in a notebook is very different from a service that answers thousands of users safely. Tomorrow you learn how AI services are deployed, configured, secured and updated without breaking things.

1. Taxi, lease, own, or a driver service

Option	Everyday comparison	Trade-off
Use a model provider's API	Taking a taxi	Easy and powerful; you follow their rules and pay per trip
Host it in your company's cloud	Leasing a car	More control and privacy; some setup
Run an open model	Owning a car	Full control; you handle fuel and repairs yourself
Managed agent runtime (NEW v4)	A car with a hired driver	Fast and convenient; check where the driver keeps your notes

2. Practice kitchen and real kitchen

Restaurants test new dishes in a practice kitchen before serving customers. Software teams use separate environments: development for building, testing for checking, production for real users. Passwords and keys, called **secrets**, are kept in a safe, never written into the recipe.

3. One front door NEW (v4)

A large office has one reception desk that checks badges, signs in visitors and keeps a log. An **AI gateway** does this for AI: every app and agent goes through it, so the company can control who uses which model, set budgets and see everything in one place. Agents get a visitor badge that expires, not a master key.

4. Changing safely

Before switching every customer to a new menu, a restaurant might offer it at a few tables first. AI teams do this too, called a **canary release**: a small share of users get the new version while the team watches the numbers.

Key idea: release changes gradually, keep keys in a vault, and make it easy to switch back.

5. Think about these before class

- Would your organisation allow its data to be stored by an external AI provider? For how long?
- Which settings would differ between a test and a live version of SmartDesk?
- Why is a key that never expires more dangerous than one that lasts five minutes?

Nagareru (流れる): to flow